

Submission S15157871

View in [eBird](#)

Created: 2013-09-12 19:17:53 EDT

Last edited: 2013-09-12 19:17:53 EDT

Observer: [Elizabeth Copper](#)

Date: Sep 11, 2013

Time: 11:30:00 AM

Location name:	Loudy Simpson Nature Trail
County:	Moffat
State/Province:	CO
Country:	US
Protocol:	Traveling
Effort:	2 hour(s)
Observers:	1
Area covered:	
Distance covered:	1.25 mile(s)
All obs. reported?	true
Elevation:	

Comments:	It was overcast and drizzling a bit off and on. My husband and I have stopped here regularly when driving between California and Minnesota and I have never seen it so birdy
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Observations

Select and change...

Validity: Reason: Notes: [X] Review complete

☐	Species - Alpha Tax Cat	Count	User notes
☐	Mississippi Kite	1	11 September 2013 We arrived at Loudy Simpson Nature Trail in Craig, CO around 11:30 and I slowly worked my way

[]	Species - Alpha Tax Cat	Count	User notes
			around the trail enjoying looking through the remarkably large number of birds that were present. I began a second circuit of the nature trail around 12:45 and continued east in a clockwise direction stopping just past the trail junction when I observed a raptor soaring above the river. I first noticed the tail which looked long but relative square and then realized the bird had long pointed wings rather than the shorter rounded wings of an accipiter. The bird circled for 2-3 minutes during with time I noted that the tail was barred and the under side of the body appeared to be lightly streaked. The flight feathers and underwings appeared to be somewhat mottled but while the sky was cloudy the bird was still somewhat backlighted and I did not observe detail in the underwing. I concluded the bird was a young Mississippi Kite based on shape and plumage and then was able to observe the bird twice taking insects in the air and eating them. It gradually circled up and was eventually lost in the clouds. I was not able to photograph the bird - too busy looking I am familiar with this species from time spent birding in Alabama and have seen Mississippi Kites in California where it is a rarity. I was using 10x42 Leica Ultravid binoculars. I was the only observer my husband was in the car with the dogs.